TRAVELSCOUT · PROJECT DOCUMENT

Competitive analysis

What group travelers can use today and where TravelScout fits.

PROJECT
TravelScout

PREPARED BY
Aditi Kela, product lead

VERSION
1.0, draft for review

DATE
October 15, 2026

CONFIRMED from the built app or from you ESTIMATE my working figure
PROPOSED a plan or target to test SOURCED from a cited public page TO CONFIRM needs your input

> Research accessed October 15, 2026. "Not found" means the page read did not say so. Third-party sources are marked. Tripadvisor and Google Travel were not covered. SOURCED

Overview

APP	WHAT IT IS	COLLABORATION	AI PLANNING	PRICES SHOWN	EXPENSE SPLITTING	PRICING
Wanderlog	Collaborative itinerary and map planner	Yes, real time; edit or view-only invites	Yes; one third-party source puts it in Pro	Hotel suggestions compared on price; flight prices not found; date and source not found	Yes, budgeting tool splits costs	Free; Pro $39.99/yr (third party)
TripIt	Organizes plans into one itinerary	Sharing of plans; real-time collaboration not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Free; Pro $49/yr
Mindtrip	AI travel assistant that plans and books	Group planning, invites; group chat per a 2024 article (third party)	Yes	Yes, with price-drop alerts; no date checked or data provider shown	Not found	Not found
Layla	AI planner with optional human advisor	Not found	Yes	Real-time comparison claimed; date and source not found	Not found	Planning free; about $49/yr tier per its blog

APP	WHAT IT IS	COLLABORATION	AI PLANNING	PRICES SHOWN	EXPENSE SPLITTING	PRICING
Splitwise	Expense splitting	Group ledgers with comments	Not found	Not found	Yes, several split types, 100+ currencies	Free (4 expenses a day); Pro and Trip Pass, amounts not found

Feature gap

FEATURE	WANDERLOG	TRIPIT	MINDTRIP	LAYLA	SPLITWISE	TRAVELSCOUT
Group chat in the planning space	Not found	Not found	Group chat (2024 article)	Not found	Comments	Yes CONFIRMED
Polls or voting	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Yes CONFIRMED
AI guide that asks questions first	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Yes CONFIRMED
Preferences for budget, pace, dietary and accessibility	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Yes CONFIRMED
Prices with date checked and source link	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Yes CONFIRMED
Itinerary	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes CONFIRMED
Expense splitting	Yes	Not found	Not found	Not found	Yes	Tab built; depth TO CONFIRM
Mobile apps	Yes	Yes	iOS	Not found	Yes	Web CONFIRMED

Where competitors are stronger

- Wanderlog: maps, real-time editing and email import, with mobile apps.
- TripIt: reservation import and flight alerts.
- Mindtrip: booking inside the app and price-drop alerts.
- Splitwise: a mature expense engine.

Where TravelScout can stand apart

- An AI guide in the group chat that asks first and shows its source, date and an estimate label.
- Preferences that include dietary and accessibility needs.
- Polls next to the conversation.
- The gap on dated, sourced prices is a gap in what I read, not proof that no competitor does it.

Implications

- Lead with trust: every price carries a date and a source. PROPOSED

- Do not try to outdo Wanderlog on maps. **PROPOSED**
- Add email import and a share link after group tests. **PROPOSED**
- Keep expense splitting simple, or link out to Splitwise. **PROPOSED**

Sources

- Wanderlog: apps.apple.com/us/app/wanderlog/id1476732439; wanderlog.com/trip-planner-ai; help.wanderlog.com/hc/en-us/articles/13302997563547-Is-Wanderlog-free; whistleout.com (published 2026-03-09, third party); monkeyeatingmango.com/blog/wanderlog-pricing-2026/ (third party, author makes a competing product); stardrift.ai/resources/wanderlog (2026-07-17)
- TripIt: tripit.com/uhp/pricing
- Mindtrip: mindtrip.ai/; mindtrip.ai/flights; resources.mindtrip.ai/travelers/help/traveler-faqs; phocuswire.com/mindtrip-secures-12m-funding-launches-group-chat (2024-09-18)
- Layla: layla.ai/about; layla.ai/blog/news-and-tips/best-free-ai-trip-planner
- Splitwise: apps.apple.com/app/id458023433; kb.splitwise.com/pro/what-is-splitwise-pro-and-who-can-use-it

Limits

- Wanderlog Pro pricing is third-party only.
- Mindtrip group chat may have changed since 2024.
- Layla's pricing statements conflict.
- Splitwise Pro dollar prices were not readable.